

Money, Bills & Shared Responsibilities — Interview Practice Questions

(answer truthfully; don't guess if unsure).

1) Banking setup (joint vs separate)

- Do you have joint bank accounts, separate accounts, or both?
- If joint: which bank/credit union (name) and what is the account used for (bills, savings)?
- If separate: do you still share expenses? How do you transfer money (Zelle, Venmo, bank transfer, cash)?
- Do you have any joint credit cards? If yes, whose name is primary?

2) Rent/mortgage and housing costs

- Do you rent or own your home?
- How much is rent/mortgage (approx) and when is it due each month?
- Who pays the rent/mortgage (one person, split, alternating)?
- How is it paid (online portal, check, bank transfer)?
- Whose name is on the lease/mortgage (if known)?
- Do you pay renters/home insurance? Who pays and how often?

3) Utilities (who pays what)

- Which utilities do you pay (electric, gas, water/sewer, trash, heat)?
- Which company names are on the bills (if you know)?
- Who pays each one and how often (monthly/quarterly)?
- Are any utilities included in rent? Which ones?
- Where do you keep utility account info and login details (folder, email, phone notes)?

4) Phone and internet

- Are you on the same phone plan or separate plans?
- Who is the account holder for phone service and what provider (if known)?
- Who pays the phone bill and how often?
- Internet provider name (if known) and whose name is on the account?
- Who pays the internet bill and how is it paid?

5) Groceries, household shopping, and everyday spending

- Who usually buys groceries?
- Do you split grocery spending or take turns?
- Do you use one shared card or separate cards for groceries?
- How often do you grocery shop and where (a couple real stores)?
- Who buys household supplies (toilet paper, detergent, cleaning products)?

6) Other regular bills and responsibilities

- Who pays for car expenses (gas, insurance, maintenance) if you share a car?
- Do you have subscriptions/memberships (Costco, Netflix, Spotify, Amazon Prime)?
- Which subscriptions are in whose name?
- How do you track subscription charges (bank statements, app, email)?
- Do you have any pets? Who pays for pet expenses?

7) How you split expenses (the agreement)

- How do you split expenses overall (50/50, proportional to income, one covers rent and the other covers groceries)?
- Was this agreed upon when you moved in together or later?
- Has the split ever changed (job change, new expenses)? When and why?
- Do you keep a written budget/spreadsheet or is it informal?

8) Handling money day-to-day

- Do you use cash often or mostly cards/apps?
- Do you reimburse each other for purchases? How (Zelle/Venmo/cash) and how quickly?
- Who is more likely to pay at restaurants or when out together?
- Do you keep receipts? Where?

9) Savings and major purchases

- Do you save together for goals (car, travel, emergencies)?
- Any major purchase made together (furniture, appliances)? What and when (approx)?
- Who paid for it and how (split, one person, financing)?

10) Documents and proof (where things are kept)

- Where do you keep important financial documents (lease, bills, insurance cards, tax papers)?
- Are documents stored physically (folder/file cabinet) or digitally (email/cloud)?
- Who has access to the online portals for bills?
- Do you have autopay set up? Which bills and whose account is used?

11) “Reality check” questions (recent and specific)

- Who paid the most recent rent/mortgage payment and how?
- Which bill was paid most recently and who paid it?
- What was your last grocery trip: where, what did you buy, and who paid?
- What subscription charge did you see most recently and whose account was it on?

Tip: If you're unsure about amounts or provider names, check your banking app/email before answering. Don't guess.